

❖❖ [Chapter 1 : ✍️ A Letter to God ✍️] ❖❖



Summary: Lencho was a hardworking farmer living on a hilltop whose corn field was his only hope, but a hailstorm destroyed his entire crop making him sad, however he had strong faith in God so he wrote a letter to God asking for 100 pesos to

sow again and feed his family, the postmaster saw the letter and was impressed by his faith so he collected 70 pesos from his staff and sent it to Lencho, but Lencho counted only 70 pesos and thought the post office staff stole 30 pesos and called them a bunch of crooks in his second letter to God.

অসমীয়া অনুবাদ: লেঞ্চো আছিল পাহাৰৰ শিখৰত বাস কৰা এজন কঠোৰ পৰিশ্ৰমী কৃষক যাৰ কুঁহিয়াৰৰ পথাৰ তেওঁৰ একমাত্ৰ আশা আছিল, কিন্তু শিলাবৃষ্টিৰ ধুমুহাই তেওঁৰ সমগ্ৰ শস্য ধ্বংস কৰি তেওঁক দুখী কৰি পেলালে, অৱশ্যে তেওঁৰ ঈশ্বৰৰ ওপৰত দৃঢ় বিশ্বাস আছিল গতিকে তেওঁ ঈশ্বৰলৈ এখন চিঠি লিখি পুনৰ বীজ সিঁচিবলৈ আৰু

পৰিয়ালক খুৱাবলৈ ১০০ পেছ' বিচাৰিছিল,
ডাকঘৰৰ মাষ্টৰে চিঠিখন দেখি তেওঁৰ বিশ্বাসত
আপ্লুত হৈছিল গতিকে তেওঁ নিজৰ পৰা ৭০ পেছ'
সংগ্ৰহ কৰিছিল লেঞ্চোলৈ পঠিয়াই দিলে, কিন্তু
লেঞ্চোৱে মাত্ৰ ৭০ পেচো গণনা কৰিলে আৰু
ভাবিলে যে ডাকঘৰৰ কৰ্মচাৰীয়ে ৩০ পেচো চুৰি
কৰিলে আৰু ভগৱানলৈ লিখা দ্বিতীয়খন চিঠিত
তেওঁলোকক এটা গোট ঠগবাজ বুলি অভিহিত
কৰিলে।

□□□Important Word Meaning□□□□□

- 1. Crop** – plants grown by farmers
- 2. Hailstorm** – storm with small balls of ice
- 3. Destroyed** – completely ruined
- 4. Faith** – strong belief
- 5. Bunch** – a group

6. Crooks – dishonest people

7. Hope – to expect something to happen

8. Downpour – heavy rain

9. Intact – not damaged

10. Conscience – inner sense of right and wrong

□□□□□ Important Questions □□□□□

Q1. Why did Lencho write a letter to God?

Ans. His crop was destroyed by hailstorm, so he asked God for 100 pesos to sow his field again.

Q2. What did the postmaster do after reading Lencho's letter?

Ans. He was impressed by Lencho's faith and collected 70 pesos from his friends and staff and sent it to Lencho.

Q3. Why did Lencho get angry after counting the money?

Ans. He got only 70 pesos instead of 100 pesos. He thought post office employees stole 30 pesos.

Q4. What kind of person was Lencho?

Ans. Lencho was a hardworking, innocent farmer with strong faith in God.

Q5. What does the story teach us?

Ans. It teaches us about blind faith and human kindness.

Q6. Why did Lencho call the post office employees crooks?

Ans. Because he thought they stole his 30 pesos sent by God.

☐☐☐Thinking about the Text☐☐

Q1. Who does Lencho have complete faith in? Which sentences in the story tell you this?

Ans. Lencho has complete faith in God.

The following sentences tell this:

1. "Lencho showed not the slightest surprise on seeing the money, such was his confidence."

2. "God could not have made a mistake, nor could he have denied Lencho what he had requested."

3. He wrote "God, if you don't help me, my family and I will go hungry."

2. Why does the postmaster send money to Lencho? Why does he sign the letter 'God'?

Ans. The postmaster sends money to Lencho because he does not want to

break Lencho's strong faith in God. He is a kind and generous man and wants to help him.

He signs the letter 'God' so that Lencho will think the money is sent by God himself and his faith remains intact.

Q3. Did Lencho try to find out who had sent the money to him? Why/Why not?

Ans. No, Lencho did not try to find out who had sent the money because he had complete faith in God. He was sure

that only God could have sent the money and no one else.

Q4. Who does Lencho think has taken the rest of the money? What is the irony in the situation?

Ans. Lencho thinks that the post office employees have taken the rest of the money. He calls them crooks.

The irony is that the employees who helped him by collecting money out of kindness are called crooks by Lencho himself.

Q5. Are there people like Lencho in the real world? What kind of a person would you say he is?

Ans. Yes, there are people like Lencho in the real world who have blind faith in God.

He is naive and unquestioning. He is not greedy or selfish, but his behaviour is a little comical and ungrateful because he calls his helpers crooks.

Q6. There are two kinds of conflict in the story: between humans and nature, and between humans

themselves. How are these conflicts illustrated?

Ans.

1. Conflict between humans and nature: The hailstorm destroys Lencho's crop. He is a farmer who depends on nature for his living. Nature's fury ruins his hard work.

2. Conflict between humans themselves: Lencho thinks post office employees are crooks who stole his money, while in reality they helped him. This shows misunderstanding between humans.

☆☆☆☆Thinking about Language☆☆☆☆

1. Look at the following sentence from the story. Suddenly a strong wind began to blow and along with the rain very large hailstones began to fall.

the matches:

- (a) A violent tropical storm in which strong winds move in a circle – cyclone
- (b) An extremely large and powerful storm caused by air going upward very quickly – tornado

(c) A violent tropical storm with very strong winds, especially in the Western Atlantic – hurricane

(d) A violent storm whose centre is a cloud in the shape of a funnel – whirlwind (or tornado)

(e) A violent storm with very strong winds, especially in the Western Pacific – typhoon

(f) A storm with strong winds – gale

(II) the matching:

1. Will you get the subjects you want to study in college? I hope so.

- wanting something to happen (and thinking it quite possible)

2. I hope you don't mind my saying this, but I don't like the way you are arguing.

- showing concern that what you say should not offend or disturb the other person: a way of being polite

3. This discovery will give new hope to HIV/AIDS sufferers.

- a feeling that something good will probably happen

4. We were hoping against hope that the judges would not notice our mistakes.

- wishing for something to happen although this is very unlikely

5. I called early in the hope of speaking to her before she went to school.

- thinking that this would happen (It may or may not have happened)

6. Just when everybody had given up hope, the fishermen came back seven days after the cyclone.

- stopped believing that this good thing would happen

(III) the joined sentences:

1. I often go to Mumbai which is the commercial capital of India.
2. My mother who cooks very well is going to host a TV show on cooking.
3. These sportspersons whose performance has been excellent are going to meet the President.
4. Lencho prayed to God whose eyes see into our minds.

5. This man whom I trusted cheated me.

(IV) Find sentences in the story with negative words, which express the following ideas emphatically.

the sentences from the story:

1. The trees lost all their leaves.

Ans. Not a leaf remained on the trees.

2. The letter was addressed to God himself.

Ans. It was nothing less than a letter to God.

3. The postman saw this address for the first time in his career.

Ans. Never in his career as a postman had he known that address.

(V) In pairs, find metaphors from the story to complete the table below. Try to say what qualities are being compared. One has been done for you.

the completetable:

1. Object: Cloud

Metaphor: Huge mountains of clouds
Quality compared: The hugeness and mass of clouds like mountains

2. Object: Raindrops

Metaphor: New coins

Quality compared: Raindrops were promising good crop and money, small and shiny like coins

3. Object: Hailstones

Metaphor: Frozen pearls / New silver coins

Quality compared: White, shiny and precious looking but very harmful

4. Object: Locusts

Metaphor: A plague of locusts

Quality compared: Large number and destructive nature like a plague / epidemic that destroys everything

5. Object: Lencho

Metaphor: An ox of a man

Quality compared: Very hardworking, strong and sturdy like an ox

6. Object: Locusts (again)

Metaphor: An epidemic (a plague) that spreads very rapidly

Quality compared: Destroys crops and spreads quickly

